

for the taskbar. The simplest is that all taskbars show only the applications running on the same monitor as the taskbar. Another option is to have all taskbars show that same thing, which is, all running applications. The third mode is to have the primary taskbar on the primary monitor show all running applications, while the other taskbars will show only the applications running on their screen.

You can pick between these three options, and enable or disable multi-display taskbars by right clicking on the taskbar, and clicking properties.



Taskbar options are a bit underwhelming, but at least they are there finally

There are still a few shortcomings of the multi-monitor taskbar that is included with Windows 8. For one, you can only pin applications to the primary task bar. Secondly, the time and date display and system tray are only included in the primary task bar. If this matters to you, you should look into third-party software for secondary toolbars which often include these features. Some examples are DisplayFusion, UltraMon, Actual Multiple Monitors etc.

Set a Custom Refresh Point

We've mentioned the Refresh feature of Windows 8 before, but just to reiterate, it is a new feature in Windows 8 that can be used to reinstall Windows in place. Refreshing your system is like a fresh Windows 8 install, but with all your data intact and all your store-bought applications available.

However, if you installed a lot of drivers and desktop applications, you might have to reinstall everything at this point, which can be a pain.

There is a solution though. You can create a custom system refresh image. Whenever you create this image it will contain a snapshot of the current state of your Windows install and including any installed desktop applications. The next time you refresh your computer, rather than resetting to a blank state, it will reset to this state.

It is still best to create this image at a point when you have on the most important applications installed; otherwise it can defeat the purpose of reinstalling Windows in the first place.